

Exact Diffusion Design for Maximally Collective Stable Turing Patterns in Binary-Complex Mass-Action Networks

Topology-Wide All-Spectrum Localization and Exponent-Optimal Heterogeneity Trade-Offs

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Abstract

Multicomponent Turing theories often seek a lower-dimensional unstable subsystem responsible for patterning. For every $n \geq 4$, we construct an n -species binary-complex classical mass-action topology for which, throughout every positive-equilibrium realization, every principal subsystem below order $n - 1$ is Hurwitz while one order- $(n - 1)$ subsystem is unstable. We prove a general principal-minor diffusion-ray theorem and obtain an exact network law: for any homogeneously stable realization, a stationary crossing occurs along a positive diagonal diffusion ray exactly when $d_Z > 8h_Z \sum_{j=2}^{n-2} d_j/h_j$. This gives the nonattained fixed-equilibrium contrast infimum, the unit-equilibrium value $8(n - 3)$, and the universal trade-off $\chi_D \chi_H > 8(n - 3)$. At unit equilibrium, an exact rational design undergoes a primary supercritical bifurcation with locally exponentially stable positive patterns. A second exact family redistributes heterogeneity between diffusion and equilibrium concentrations so that both contrasts are $\Theta(\sqrt{n})$, matching the universal minimax lower bound in exponent. The proof uses explicit flux-cone design, exhaustive strongly connected block classification, conservation-compatible Lyapunov-Schmidt reduction, and inspectable symbolic certificates. The networks are synthetic; the bifurcation, stability, and robustness conclusions are local for each fixed dimension, and the stationary diffusion law does not classify arbitrary wave instability.

1 Introduction

Turing's diffusion-driven instability mechanism shows how a spatially homogeneous equilibrium can be stable in a well-mixed system and unstable to a nonconstant spatial mode after species-dependent diffusion is introduced [15]. For systems with many components, a central structural question is whether the instability can always be attributed to a smaller unstable subsystem. General matrix theories allow responsible principal subsystems of orders up to $n - 1$ and distinguish stationary from wave instabilities [13, 1, 18, 17]. Reaction-network approaches instead constrain the Jacobian by stoichiometry, positive steady fluxes, and mass-action derivatives [10, 4, 14, 16].

A large unstable block in one numerical Jacobian does not settle the reaction-topology question. Reparameterizing the same network can change its Jacobian and can expose a smaller unstable subsystem. Our first result closes this quantifier exactly: for one explicit indexed topology, every positive rate/equilibrium realization has all principal blocks below order $n - 1$ Hurwitz. Thus the upper endpoint $n - 1$ in principal-subsystem localization cannot be lowered even within a highly restricted classical mass-action class.

The second question is quantitative. Differential diffusion is often presented as an empirical tuning parameter, whereas the present topology admits a complete exact design law. A single signed order- $(n - 1)$ minor is negative, and the remaining omission minors are positive or zero. This network-specific one-bad-minor structure reduces stationary diffusion design to one strict linear inequality and yields sharp

heterogeneity lower bounds. We further show that the same topology supports primary supercritical bifurcations and locally exponentially stable patterns with substantially reduced diffusion contrast, as well as a stable diffusion–equilibrium trade-off whose two contrasts grow only as the square root of dimension.

Linear Turing instability alone does not guarantee a persistent nonlinear pattern [8]. We therefore prove the primary crossing, the conservation-compatible branch, the exact cubic sign, exchange of stability, and local semilinear stability separately. Related weakly nonlinear analyses for minimal two-species schemes demonstrate the importance of this additional layer [19, 20].

Theorem suite. For every $n = m + 1 \geq 4$, one indexed binary-complex topology has:

1. a complete two-flux-parameter family of all positive-equilibrium Jacobians;
2. topology-wide maximum all-spectrum localization order $n - 1$;
3. an exact necessary-and-sufficient stationary diffusion criterion and a unique positive threshold on each eligible diffusion ray;
4. the sharp fixed-equilibrium diffusion-contrast infimum, including $8(m - 2)$ at the unit equilibrium;
5. a rational unit-equilibrium supercritical stable-pattern realization;
6. a one-parameter stable family with $\chi_D, \chi_H = \Theta(\sqrt{m})$, matching the universal minimax lower bound in exponent.

The topology was deliberately designed so that its positive-flux image and induced strongly connected blocks are explicit; no black-box real-algebraic elimination is used.

Scope. The network has one *semipositive* conservation law: the conserved functional does not contain X_1 . Accordingly we call the system stoichiometric-codimension one, not conservative or mass conserving. The construction is synthetic and not proposed as a natural biochemical mechanism. All species diffuse with positive diagonal coefficients. The pattern, stability, and robustness statements are local for each fixed m ; no arbitrary-data global existence, global attraction, dimension-uniform basin, cross-diffusion, or immobile-species theorem is claimed.

2 Reaction family and complete realization space

An indexed classical mass-action network has reactions $y_r \rightarrow y'_r$, source matrix $Y = [y_1 \cdots y_R]$, and stoichiometric matrix $\Gamma = [y'_1 - y_1 \cdots y'_R - y_R]$. We call it *binary-complex* when

$$|y_r|_1 \leq 2, \quad |y'_r|_1 \leq 2 \tag{1}$$

for every reaction. This condition restricts both source and product molecularity and is stronger than conventions that bound only reactant order.

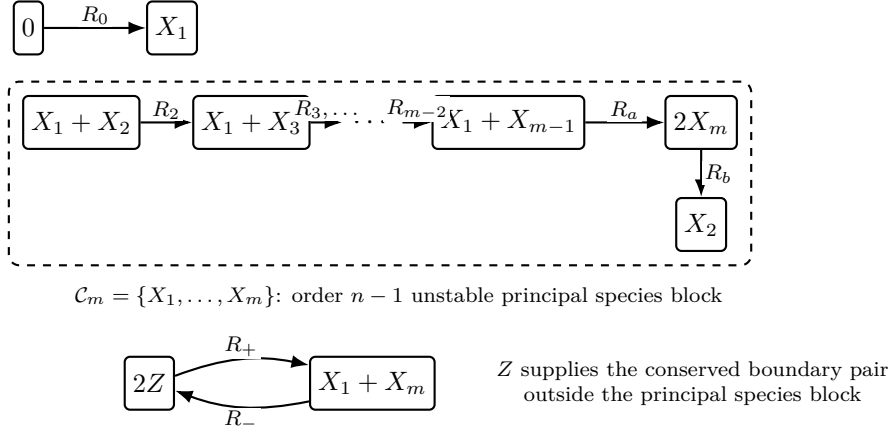
At a positive equilibrium x^* define

$$v_r = k_r (x^*)^{y_r}, \quad h_i = (x_i^*)^{-1}, \quad H = \text{diag}(h). \tag{2}$$

Then $v > 0$, $\Gamma v = 0$, and direct differentiation gives

$$J = \Gamma \text{diag}(v) Y^T H. \tag{3}$$

Conversely, every $v > 0$ in $\ker \Gamma$ and every $H \succ 0$ are physically realized by $x_i^* = h_i^{-1}$ and $k_r = v_r / (x^*)^{y_r}$.



Synthetic indexed topology; the semipositive conserved functional omits X_1 .

Figure 1: The synthetic topology $\hat{N}_m$. The shaded principal species set $C_m = \{X_1, \dots, X_m\}$ is the unique order- $(n - 1)$ block with negative signed determinant. The separate Z boundary pair controls the exact diffusion law.

For $m \geq 3$, let $\hat{N}_m$ have species $X_1, \dots, X_m, Z$ and reactions



The chain range is empty at $m = 3$. Writing $n = m + 1$, the family has n species and $n + 1$ indexed reactions and satisfies (1).

Proposition 2.1 (Semipositive conservation and flux cone). *Let*

$$c = (0, \underbrace{4, \dots, 4}_{X_2, \dots, X_{m-1}}, 2, 1)^T. \quad (10)$$

Then

$$c^T \Gamma_m = 0, \quad \text{rank } \Gamma_m = m, \quad \text{im } \Gamma_m = c^\perp, \quad (11)$$

and

$$\ker \Gamma_m = \text{span}\{(\mathbf{1}_m, 0, 0), (0_m, 1, 1)\}. \quad (12)$$

Consequently

$$\{v > 0 : \Gamma_m v = 0\} = \{(a\mathbf{1}_m, b, b) : a, b > 0\}. \quad (13)$$

The functional $c^T x$ is semipositive: it does not bound X_1 .

Proof. Each reaction vector is orthogonal to c . The X_i balance equations along the long circuit successively equate its m reaction fluxes, and the Z balance equates the final reversible pair. The two displayed kernel vectors are independent. Deleting one reaction from each circuit leaves an explicit $m \times m$ triangular stoichiometric minor with nonzero diagonal, so the rank is m . The image and positive-cone statements follow. $\square$

At unit equilibrium and flux $(a\mathbf{1}_m, b, b)$, the vector field is

$$\begin{aligned}
\dot{x}_1 &= a - ax_1x_{m-1} + bz^2 - bx_1x_m, \\
\dot{x}_2 &= -ax_1x_2 + ax_m^2, \\
\dot{x}_i &= ax_1x_{i-1} - ax_1x_i, \\
\dot{x}_m &= 2ax_1x_{m-1} - 2ax_m^2 + bz^2 - bx_1x_m, \\
\dot{z} &= -2bz^2 + 2bx_1x_m.
\end{aligned} \tag{14}$$

The nonzero entries of its Jacobian factor $A_m(a, b)$ are

$$\begin{aligned}
A_{11} &= -(a+b), & A_{1,m-1} &= -a, & A_{1m} &= -b, & A_{1Z} &= 2b, \\
A_{21} &= -a, & A_{22} &= -a, & A_{2m} &= 2a, \\
A_{i,i-1} &= a, & A_{ii} &= -a, & & & & 3 \leq i \leq m-1, \\
A_{m1} &= 2a-b, & A_{m,m-1} &= 2a, & A_{mm} &= -(4a+b), & A_{mZ} &= 2b, \\
A_{Z1} &= 2b, & A_{Zm} &= 2b, & A_{ZZ} &= -4b.
\end{aligned} \tag{15}$$

Proposition 2.2 (Complete realization family). *Every positive-equilibrium Jacobian of $\hat{N}_m$ is exactly*

$$J_m(a, b, H) = A_m(a, b)H, \quad a, b > 0, \quad H \succ 0 \text{ diagonal.} \tag{16}$$

Conversely every triple in (16) is realized by positive rates and a positive equilibrium.

Proof. The forward direction is Eqs. (3) and (13). For the converse, choose $x_i^* = h_i^{-1}$, flux $(a\mathbf{1}_m, b, b)$, and $k_r = v_r/(x^*)^{y_r} > 0$. $\square$

3 Maximum topology-wide all-spectrum localization

For a real square matrix M , write $\alpha(M) = \max\{\Re \lambda : \lambda \in \sigma(M)\}$.

Lemma 3.1 (Exhaustive strongly connected blocks). *Let I be a principal species set with $|I| < m$. Every nontrivial strongly connected component of the induced Jacobian graph on I is one of*

1. *the complete long cycle $X_1, \dots, X_{m-1}$;*
2. *the complete long cycle $X_2, \dots, X_m$;*
3. *a principal subgraph of the boundary triad $\{X_1, X_m, Z\}$;*
4. *a negative singleton.*

After a simultaneous permutation of rows and columns, every principal matrix with $|I| < m$ is block upper triangular with diagonal blocks of these forms. On the hypersurface $b = 2a$, the edge $X_1 \rightarrow X_m$ is absent; this can only split components and hence refines the same classification.

Proof. Use the directed convention $X_j \rightarrow X_i$ when the (i, j) Jacobian entry is nonzero. Along the interior chain the only off-diagonal arrows are $X_i \rightarrow X_{i+1}$ for $2 \leq i \leq m-2$. Thus a retained proper chain segment cannot close by itself.

A component containing an interior chain arrow can close in only two ways. If it reaches X_{m-1} and returns through $X_{m-1} \rightarrow X_1$, then strong connectivity forces every vertex $X_1, \dots, X_{m-1}$: the only path from X_1 back through the chain successively uses $X_2, \dots, X_{m-1}$. This is the first long cycle. If it reaches X_m and returns through $X_m \rightarrow X_2$, then strong connectivity forces every vertex $X_2, \dots, X_m$; this is

the second long cycle. The other potential chain closure $X_1 \rightarrow X_2 \rightarrow \dots \rightarrow X_m \rightarrow X_1$ already uses m vertices and is excluded by $|I| < m$.

Each complete long cycle has $m - 1$ vertices. Adding any further boundary vertex therefore gives at least m retained vertices, again excluded. If no complete long cycle occurs, every feedback path involving no interior chain lies entirely inside $\{X_1, X_m, Z\}$: the arrows among those vertices are the only remaining off-diagonal boundary arrows. Every retained chain vertex outside such a feedback component has no return path and hence forms a singleton diagonal block with negative diagonal entry. Frobenius permutation gives the asserted block-triangular form. When $b = 2a$, the sole parameter-dependent arrow $X_1 \rightarrow X_m$ disappears. Deleting an arrow cannot merge strongly connected components, so no new case arises. $\square$

Theorem 3.2 (Maximal all-spectrum localization). *For every $m \geq 3$, $a, b > 0$, positive diagonal H , and principal set I with $|I| < m$,*

$$\alpha(J_m(a, b, H)_{I, I}) < 0. \quad (17)$$

For $\mathcal{C}_m = \{X_1, \dots, X_m\}$, the block $J_{\mathcal{C}_m, \mathcal{C}_m}$ has a positive real eigenvalue. Thus every positive realization of the topology satisfies

$$\min\{|I| : \alpha(J_{I, I}) > 0\} = m = n - 1. \quad (18)$$

No smaller principal subsystem supports either stationary or oscillatory instability.

Proof. For the first long cycle, a closed-right-half-plane root would force

$$\prod_{i=1}^{m-1} |\lambda + \delta_i h_i| = a^{m-1} \prod_{i=1}^{m-1} h_i, \quad \delta_1 = a + b, \quad \delta_i = a \ (i \geq 2),$$

but the left side is at least $(a + b)a^{m-2} \prod h_i > a^{m-1} \prod h_i$. For the second long cycle, the corresponding diagonal product is $(4a + b)a^{m-2} \prod h_i$, strictly larger than the cycle product $4a^{m-1} \prod h_i$.

The full boundary triad has characteristic polynomial $\lambda^3 + c_1 \lambda^2 + c_2 \lambda + c_3$, where

$$\begin{aligned} c_1 &= ah_1 + 4ah_m + bh_1 + bh_m + 4bh_Z, \\ c_2 &= a(4ah_1h_m + 7bh_1h_m + 4bh_1h_Z + 16bh_mh_Z), \\ c_3 &= 16a^2bh_1h_mh_Z. \end{aligned} \quad (19)$$

All coefficients are positive, and $c_1c_2 - c_3$ is a times fourteen strictly positive monomials (Supplement, Section S2). The cubic Routh–Hurwitz criterion and direct one- and two-dimensional checks establish Hurwitz stability of every triad principal block. The result for all smaller sets follows from Theorem 3.1 and Frobenius block triangularization.

Finally, sparse chain expansion gives

$$(-1)^m \det J_{\mathcal{C}_m, \mathcal{C}_m} = -2a^{m-1}b \prod_{i=1}^m h_i < 0. \quad (20)$$

Its characteristic polynomial is negative at zero and positive for large positive λ , so the block has a positive real eigenvalue. $\square$

Corollary 3.3 (Sharpness of the general subsystem-order endpoint). *The upper endpoint $n - 1$ in principal unstable-subsystem localization cannot be lowered within binary-complex classical mass action: for every $n \geq 4$, one indexed topology has every principal subsystem below order $n - 1$ Hurwitz throughout every positive realization, while an order- $(n - 1)$ subsystem is unstable and the full reaction–diffusion system admits locally stable patterns.*

4 A principal-minor diffusion-ray theorem

Theorem 4.1 (Principal-minor diffusion ray). *For $I \subseteq [n]$, set $a_I = (-1)^{|I|} \det J_{I,I}$ and $a_\emptyset = 1$. Let $J \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ satisfy*

$$\det J = 0, \quad a_I > 0 \quad (|I| \leq n-2), \quad \sum_{|I|=n-1} a_I > 0. \quad (21)$$

For $D = \text{diag}(d_1, \dots, d_n) \succ 0$, define $p_D(s) = \det(sD - J)$. Then

$$p_D(s) = s\{\beta_1(D) + \beta_2(D)s + \dots + \beta_n(D)s^{n-1}\}, \quad (22)$$

where

$$\beta_k(D) = \sum_{|I|=n-k} a_I \prod_{j \notin I} d_j, \quad \beta_k(D) > 0 \quad (k \geq 2). \quad (23)$$

A nonzero stationary threshold exists on the ray sD if and only if $\beta_1(D) < 0$. In that case there is a unique simple $s_ > 0$, and*

$$J - sD \text{ has a positive real eigenvalue} \iff 0 < s < s_*. \quad (24)$$

For $s > s_$ no positive real eigenvalue exists. The theorem does not exclude a nonreal unstable pair outside this interval.*

Proof. Principal-minor expansion gives Eqs. (22) and (23); the constant term vanishes because $\det J = 0$. For $k \geq 2$, every summand has $|I| \leq n-2$ and is strictly positive. Hence the bracket in (22) is strictly increasing on $s \geq 0$, proving the threshold criterion, uniqueness, and scalar simplicity. Since $p_D(s) = \det(D) \det(sI - D^{-1}J)$, scalar simplicity is algebraic simplicity of the zero eigenvalue of $J - s_*D$.

For fixed $s > 0$,

$$\chi_s(\lambda) = \det(\lambda I + sD - J) = \sum_I a_I \prod_{j \notin I} (\lambda + sd_j). \quad (25)$$

In $\chi'_s(\lambda)$, every contribution with $|I| \leq n-2$ is positive for $\lambda \geq 0$. The total contribution from $|I| = n-1$ is the positive number $\sum_{|I|=n-1} a_I$ in (21), while the full-order contribution vanishes. Therefore $\chi'_s(\lambda) > 0$ for all $\lambda \geq 0$. Since $\chi_s(0) = p_D(s)$ and $\chi_s(\lambda) \rightarrow \infty$, the exact band (24) follows. $\square$

Remark 4.2. The coefficient hypotheses (21) are the theorem's exact domain. They hold, in particular, when zero is algebraically simple, the remaining spectrum is stable, and all principal blocks of order at most $n-2$ are Hurwitz: the order- $(n-1)$ sum is the positive coefficient of λ in $\det(\lambda I - J)$. No restriction on the number of negative order- $(n-1)$ minors is needed in the general theorem.

5 Exact diffusion design and sharp linear contrast

The all-spectrum theorem supplies the lower-order hypotheses of Theorem 4.1. The remaining information is the complete order- m omission table.

Proposition 5.1 (Order- $(n-1)$ omission minors). *For $J = A_m(a, b)H$,*

$$(-1)^m \det J_{\widehat{Z}, \widehat{Z}} = -2a^{m-1}b \prod_{i=1}^m h_i, \quad (26)$$

$$(-1)^m \det J_{\widehat{X_j}, \widehat{X_j}} = 16a^{m-1}bh_Z \prod_{\substack{1 \leq i \leq m \\ i \neq j}} h_i, \quad 2 \leq j \leq m-1, \quad (27)$$

$$\det J_{\widehat{X_1}, \widehat{X_1}} = \det J_{\widehat{X_m}, \widehat{X_m}} = 0. \quad (28)$$

Consequently

$$\beta_1(D) = 2a^{m-1}b \left(\prod_{i=1}^m h_i \right) \left[8h_Z \sum_{j=2}^{m-1} \frac{d_j}{h_j} - d_Z \right]. \quad (29)$$

Proof. Positive right multiplication by H multiplies each principal determinant by the product of its selected h_i , so it suffices to identify the unit- H coefficients.

Omitting Z leaves the complete X -chain block. Its two surviving cycle covers give the sparse determinant (20), hence (26). Now omit an interior species X_j , $2 \leq j \leq m-1$. Permute the retained vertices into the feed-forward chain fragments followed by $\{X_1, X_m, Z\}$. The matrix is block triangular. The $m-3$ retained interior chain vertices outside the boundary block contribute signed singleton factors ah_i . The boundary triad contributes

$$(-1)^3 \det J_{\{X_1, X_m, Z\}, \{X_1, X_m, Z\}} = 16a^2b h_1 h_m h_Z,$$

the constant coefficient in (19). Multiplication gives (27), including the factor a^{m-3} . If X_1 is omitted, the restriction of the semipositive conservation vector is a nonzero left nullvector. If X_m is omitted, the restriction of $H^{-1}(2, -2, \dots, -2, 0, 1)^T$ is a nonzero right nullvector because its X_m coordinate is zero. This proves (28).

In the coefficient β_1 , each order- m signed minor is multiplied by the diffusivity of its omitted species. Factoring the common positive quantity yields (29). The structural coefficient 8 is exactly $16/2$: the positive weight of each interior omission divided by the magnitude of the unique negative Z omission. $\square$

Define the homogeneously stable realization domain

$$\mathfrak{S}_m = \{(a, b, H) : a, b > 0, H \succ 0 \text{ diagonal}, J_m(a, b, H)|_{c^\perp} \text{ is Hurwitz}\}. \quad (30)$$

The complete region $\mathfrak{S}_m$ is not classified here. In particular, the necessary inequality $T(H) > 1$ below is not asserted to be sufficient for homogeneous stability.

Theorem 5.2 (Exact stationary diffusion law). *Assume $(a, b, H) \in \mathfrak{S}_m$. A nonzero stationary crossing occurs on the positive ray sD if and only if*

$$d_Z > 8h_Z \sum_{j=2}^{m-1} \frac{d_j}{h_j}. \quad (31)$$

When (31) holds, the threshold $s_*(H, D)$ is unique and simple, and the exact positive-real-eigenvalue interval is $0 < s < s_*$. Scaling $D \mapsto \gamma D$ sends $s_* \mapsto s_*/\gamma$.

Proof. Combine Theorems 4.1 and 5.1. A second derivation uses the left vector c and the right zero vector

$$r_0 = H^{-1}(2, -2, \dots, -2, 0, 1)^T.$$

Then

$$\lambda'_0(0) = -\frac{c^T D r_0}{c^T r_0}, \quad c^T D r_0 = \frac{d_Z}{h_Z} - 8 \sum_{j=2}^{m-1} \frac{d_j}{h_j},$$

while

$$c^T r_0 = h_Z^{-1} - 8 \sum_{j=2}^{m-1} h_j^{-1} < 0.$$

The last inequality follows from the positive equal-damping coefficient $\beta_1(\mathbf{1}) > 0$. Hence the conservation eigenvalue initially moves right exactly under (31). $\square$

For a Neumann interval $(0, L)$, mode k has $s = q_k^2 = (k\pi/L)^2$. Therefore every mode with $q_k^2 < s_*$ has a positive real eigenvalue, and no mode with $q_k^2 > s_*$ has one. A separate spectral certificate is required to exclude wave instability for a chosen diffusion profile.

Theorem 5.3 (Sharp contrast and heterogeneity trade-off). *Fix $(a, b, H) \in \mathfrak{S}_m$ and define*

$$T(H) = 8h_Z \sum_{j=2}^{m-1} \frac{1}{h_j}, \quad \chi_D = \frac{d_{\max}}{d_{\min}}, \quad \chi_H = \frac{h_{\max}}{h_{\min}} = \frac{x_{\max}^*}{x_{\min}^*}. \quad (32)$$

Homogeneous stability implies $T(H) > 1$, and

$$\inf\{\chi_D : D \succ 0 \text{ satisfies (31)}\} = T(H). \quad (33)$$

The infimum is not attained. At $H = I$,

$$\inf \chi_D = 8(m-2). \quad (34)$$

Every stationary crossing satisfies the universal strict trade-off

$$\boxed{\chi_D \chi_H > 8(m-2)}. \quad (35)$$

The product lower bound is sharp as an infimum over homogeneously stable realizations admitting a stationary crossing.

Proof. If (31) holds, then $d_Z > d_{\min}T(H)$ and $d_{\max} \geq d_Z$, so $\chi_D > T(H)$. Conversely set all X -species diffusivities to one and $d_Z = T(H) + \varepsilon$. This proves (33) and its strict nonattainment. The unit formula follows immediately. Since $h_Z/h_j \geq 1/\chi_H$, one has $T(H) \geq 8(m-2)/\chi_H$, yielding (35). The unit realization belongs to $\mathfrak{S}_m$; taking $H = I$ and the approaching diffusion sequence shows sharpness over homogeneously stable realizations admitting a stationary crossing. Equal diffusion cannot destabilize because $J - sdI$ shifts the stable nonzero spectrum and the conservation zero strictly left. $\square$

6 A supercritical stable unit-equilibrium design

Set $a = b = 1$, $H = I$, $x^* = \mathbf{1}$, and

$$K_i = 91m - 181 - i. \quad (36)$$

Define the critical vector

$$r_1 = 1, \quad r_i = -\frac{K_i}{63(m-2)} \quad (2 \leq i \leq m-1), \quad r_m = -\frac{2}{9}, \quad r_Z = \frac{5}{14}, \quad (37)$$

and diffusion profile

$$d_1 = \frac{23}{63}, \quad d_i = \frac{1}{K_i} \quad (2 \leq i \leq m-1), \quad d_m = \frac{1}{7}, \quad d_Z = \frac{16}{45}. \quad (38)$$

All entries are positive. Here $d_{\min} = d_2 = (91m - 183)^{-1}$ and $d_{\max} = d_1 = 23/63$, so

$$\chi_D^{\text{unit}}(m) = \frac{23(91m - 183)}{63}. \quad (39)$$

Theorem 6.1 (Primary supercritical stable design). *On $(0, \pi)$ with Neumann conditions, consider*

$$\partial_t x = f_m(x) + (1 - \mu)D_m \partial_{\xi\xi} x, \quad (40)$$

with (38). For every $m \geq 3$:

1. the well-mixed Jacobian, equivalently the homogeneous $k = 0$ mode restricted to $c^\perp$, is stable;
2. at $\mu = 0$ the first nonzero mode has one algebraically simple zero with right vector (37); every other first-mode eigenvalue and every higher mode is stable, and no complex pair is critical;
3. the crossing is transverse;
4. a conservation-compatible Lyapunov–Schmidt reduction has

$$\dot{A} = \eta_m \mu A + c_m A^3 + O(|A|^5 + |A|^3 |\mu| + |A| |\mu|^2), \quad \eta_m > 0, \quad c_m < 0; \quad (41)$$

5. for sufficiently small $\mu > 0$, the two positive nonconstant branches are locally exponentially asymptotically stable in the fixed-integrated-mass H^1 phase space.

Consequently

$$8(m-2) \leq \chi_{\text{stable}}(m) \leq \frac{23(91m-183)}{63}. \quad (42)$$

Proof architecture. The homogeneous characteristic determinant is

$$\det(\lambda I - A_m) = \lambda q_m(\lambda), \quad \lambda q_m = (1 + \lambda)^{m-3} P(\lambda) - R(\lambda), \quad (43)$$

where $P = \lambda^4 + 12\lambda^3 + 42\lambda^2 + 47\lambda + 16$ and $R = 5\lambda^2 + 33\lambda + 16$. The exact difference $|1 + \lambda|^2 |P|^2 - |R|^2$ has 35 nonnegative monomials in $\Re \lambda$ and $(\Im \lambda)^2$, with equality only at the origin.

For damping tD_m , sparse chain elimination gives

$$\det(\lambda I - A_m + tD_m) = Q_m F - G, \quad (44)$$

where $Q_m = \prod_{i=2}^{m-1} (\lambda + 1 + t/K_i)$ and the fixed boundary factors are

$$g_1 = \lambda + 2 + \frac{23}{63}t, \quad g_m = \lambda + 5 + \frac{1}{7}t, \quad g_Z = \lambda + 4 + \frac{16}{45}t, \\ F = g_1 g_m g_Z - 4g_1 - 4g_m + g_Z, \quad G = g_Z(4g_1 + g_m) - 36.$$

At onset $\prod_{i=2}^{m-1} (1 + 1/K_i) = 91/90$. Retaining one exact chain factor yields a 77-term nonnegative modulus certificate, strict except at $(\lambda, t) = (0, 1)$. This proves the complete primary mode statement. An exact left vector is

$$\ell_1 = -\frac{266}{815}, \quad \ell_i = \frac{78260(m-2)}{163(91m-180-i)}, \quad \ell_m = \frac{18368}{7335}, \quad \ell_Z = 1, \quad (45)$$

with $2 \leq i \leq m-1$. Exact harmonic-sum formulas give $\ell^T r < 0$ and $\ell^T D_m r < 0$, hence $\eta_m = (\ell^T D_m r)/(\ell^T r) > 0$.

The reaction field is quadratic: $f_m(\mathbf{1} + u) = A_m u + \frac{1}{2} B_m(u, u)$, with $c^T B_m = 0$. Since $\cos^2 \xi = (1 + \cos 2\xi)/2$, the stable corrections solve

$$A_m w_0 = -\frac{1}{4} B_m(r, r), \quad c^T w_0 = 0, \quad (A_m - 4D_m) w_2 = -\frac{1}{4} B_m(r, r). \quad (46)$$

The interior w_2 recurrence telescopes through four consecutive K_i factors. Fourier projection gives

$$c_m = \frac{\ell^T \{B_m(r, w_0) + \frac{1}{2} B_m(r, w_2)\}}{\ell^T r}. \quad (47)$$

Its numerator reduces to $R_m + C_m \mathcal{H}_m$ with $\mathcal{H}_m = \sum_{j=1}^{m-2} K_j^{-1}$. The exact shifted-polynomial certificate proves the numerator positive and the denominator negative for all $m \geq 3$, hence $c_m < 0$.

Crandall–Rabinowitz gives branches $A_\pm(\mu) = \pm \sqrt{-\eta_m \mu / c_m} + O(\mu^{3/2})$. The center eigenvalue is $-2\eta_m \mu + O(\mu^2) < 0$; the complementary gap persists. On the real fixed-mass L^2 space, positive Neumann diffusion with domain H_N^2 is sectorial, while in one dimension the quadratic Nemytskii map is smooth from H^1 to L^2 . The principle of linearized stability then gives local exponential asymptotic stability in H^1 [3, 6, 5, 7]. The complete coefficient tables and algebra appear in the Supplement. $\square$

7 A stable diffusion–equilibrium trade-off family

Put $\nu = m - 2$ and retain the effective diffusion matrix Δ_m from (38). Define

$$L_0(\nu) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3\nu}}, \quad L_1(\nu) = \frac{90\nu}{90\nu + 1}. \quad (48)$$

The lower endpoint $L_0(\nu)$ is the boundary of the present exact modulus certificate through $\nu L^2 \geq 1/3$; it is not asserted to be an intrinsic dynamical boundary of the family. For $L \in [L_0(\nu), L_1(\nu)]$, set

$$h_1 = h_m = h_Z = 1, \quad h_i = \frac{K_i}{LK_{i-1}} \quad (2 \leq i \leq m-1), \quad \mathbf{H}_m(L) = \text{diag}(h), \quad (49)$$

and choose

$$D_m^{\text{phys}}(L) = \mathbf{H}_m(L)\Delta_m, \quad x^* = \mathbf{H}_m(L)^{-1}\mathbf{1}. \quad (50)$$

Positive rates realizing unit reaction flux are given by $k_r = (x^*)^{-y_r}$.

Theorem 7.1 (Stable exponent-optimal trade-off). *For every $m \geq 3$ and $L \in [L_0(\nu), L_1(\nu)]$, the physical realization (49)–(50) has a primary simple transverse first-mode stationary bifurcation, a negative cubic coefficient, and two nearby positive locally exponentially asymptotically stable patterned equilibria. Its physical contrasts are*

$$\chi_D(L) = \frac{23}{63} 91\nu L, \quad (51)$$

$$\chi_H(L) = \frac{91\nu - 1}{91\nu L}, \quad (52)$$

$$\chi_D(L)\chi_H(L) = \frac{23(91\nu - 1)}{63}. \quad (53)$$

At $L = L_0$,

$$\chi_D = \frac{2093}{63\sqrt{3}}\sqrt{\nu}, \quad \chi_H = \sqrt{3\nu}\frac{91\nu - 1}{91\nu}. \quad (54)$$

Thus both contrasts are $\Theta(\sqrt{m})$. Since every stationary crossing obeys

$$\max(\chi_D, \chi_H) > \sqrt{8(m-2)}, \quad (55)$$

the simultaneous exponent $1/2$ is globally optimal. No constant-optimality or complete global Pareto-frontier claim is made.

Proof architecture. In normalized concentrations $z = \mathbf{H}_m(L)x$, the PDE is

$$z_t = \mathbf{H}_m(L)\{f_m(z) + \Delta_m z_{\xi\xi}\}. \quad (56)$$

The stationary bracket $f_m(z) + \Delta_m z_{\xi\xi}$ and its critical right vector are unchanged. The dynamic left vector is $q_m(L) = \mathbf{H}_m(L)^{-1}\ell_m$, and the physical fixed-mass vector becomes $\mathbf{H}_m(L)^{-1}c$.

For $2 \leq i \leq m-1$, chain elimination gives

$$g_i = \frac{\lambda}{h_i} + 1 + \frac{t}{K_i} = \frac{K_{i-1}}{K_i}(1 + L\lambda) + \frac{t-1}{K_i}.$$

If $t \geq 1$ and $\lambda = x + iy$ with $x \geq 0$, then

$$|Q_m|^2 \geq \left(\frac{91}{90}\right)^2 |1 + L\lambda|^{2\nu} \geq \left(\frac{91}{90}\right)^2 \left(1 + 2\nu Lx + \frac{1}{3}y^2\right),$$

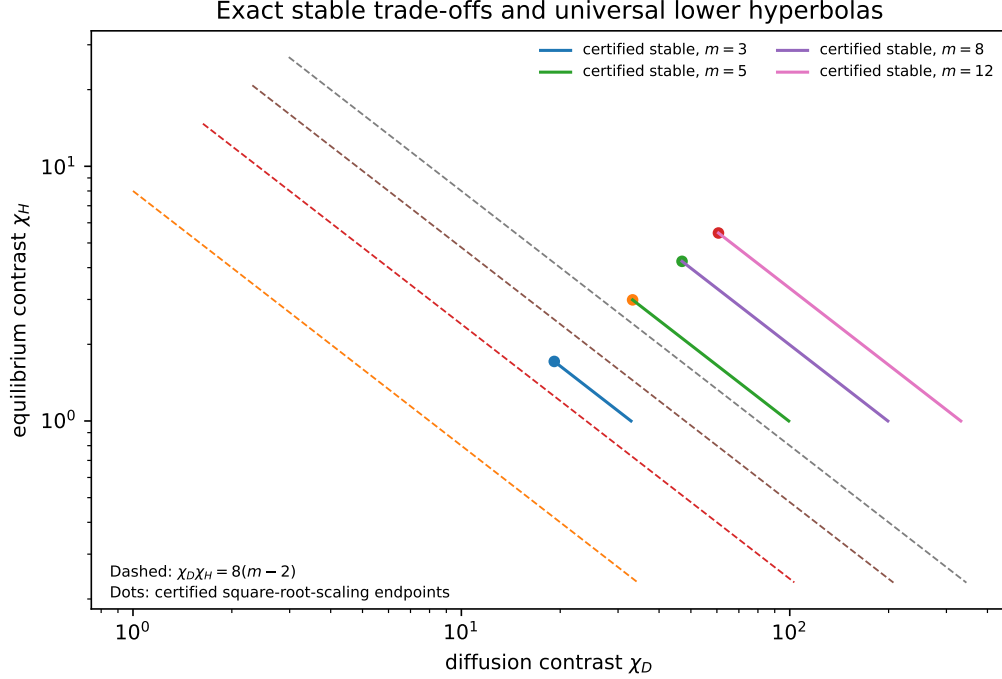


Figure 2: Exact heterogeneity trade-offs for representative dimensions. The dashed hyperbolas are the universal necessary bounds $\chi_D \chi_H = 8(m-2)$; the solid curves are certified stable families with product $23(91(m-2)-1)/63$. The marked point is the certified square-root-scaling endpoint. Constants are not claimed optimal.

because $\nu L^2 \geq 1/3$. The corresponding boundary difference has 84 nonnegative monomials and equality only at $(\lambda, t) = (0, 1)$. A separate 34-term certificate proves homogeneous relative stability. Hence the primary mode and all higher-mode conclusions hold throughout the certified interval.

The proof then follows the physical-to-normalized chain explicitly. The positive equilibrium is $x^* = H_m(L)^{-1} \mathbf{1}$, the physical diffusion is $D_m^{\text{phys}} = H_m(L) \Delta_m$, and the change $z = H_m(L)x$ produces the row-scaled mode operator $H_m(L)(A_m - t\Delta_m)$. The left critical vector becomes $q_m(L) = H_m(L)^{-1} \ell_m$ and the fixed-mass covector becomes $H_m(L)^{-1} c$. The second harmonic is unchanged by the invertible row factor. The homogeneous correction changes by a kernel gauge:

$$w_0(L) = w_0^{\text{ref}} + \tau_m(L) \rho_m, \quad \tau_m(L) = -\frac{(H_m(L)^{-1} c)^T w_0^{\text{ref}}}{(H_m(L)^{-1} c)^T \rho_m}. \quad (57)$$

The exact cubic numerator is

$$N_m(L) = N_m^{\text{ref}} + \tau_m(L) S_m. \quad (58)$$

The symbolic bounds $N_m^{\text{ref}} > 1/100$, $-1/10 < S_m < 0$, and $\tau_m(L) < 1/20$ imply $N_m(L) > 1/200$. Their complete shifted coefficient lists are printed in the Supplement and regenerated by `python verify_symbolic_certificates.py`. Meanwhile

$$\ell_m^T H_m(L)^{-1} r_m = -\frac{485873}{924210} - \frac{11180}{1467} L\nu < 0.$$

Therefore $\eta_m(L) > 0$ and $c_m(L) < 0$. The branch and stability proof is the same sectorial exchange-of-stability argument as in Theorem 6.1. The contrast formulas follow by comparing the explicit entries of $H_m(L)$ and $D_m^{\text{phys}}(L)$ on the interval (48). Finally (55) is the geometric-mean consequence of (35). $\square$

m	n	χ_D^{unit}	χ_D^{scale}	χ_H^{scale}	product	lower	η_m	c_m	$\sqrt{-\eta_m/c_m}$
3	4	32.8571	19.1809	1.71302	32.8571	2.82843	0.0192752	-0.00244362	2.80855
4	5	66.0794	27.1258	2.43603	66.0794	4	0.00992406	-0.00135495	2.70635
5	6	99.3016	33.2222	2.98901	99.3016	4.89898	0.00668208	-0.000932507	2.67689
6	7	132.524	38.3617	3.45458	132.524	5.65685	0.00503668	-0.000710298	2.66288
7	8	165.746	42.8897	3.86447	165.746	6.32456	0.00404149	-0.000573473	2.65469
8	9	198.968	46.9833	4.23487	198.968	6.9282	0.00337468	-0.000480799	2.64932
9	10	232.19	50.7478	4.57538	232.19	7.48331	0.00289675	-0.000413892	2.64553
10	11	265.413	54.2517	4.89225	265.413	8	0.0025374	-0.000363322	2.6427

Table 1: Current-profile diagnostics generated from one exact source. χ_D^{unit} is the current unit-equilibrium stable-profile contrast; χ_D^{scale} and χ_H^{scale} are the physical contrasts at the certified square-root-scaling endpoint; “product” is their exact product $23(91(m-2)-1)/63$; “lower” is $\sqrt{8(m-2)}$; and η_m , c_m , and $\sqrt{-\eta_m/c_m}$ use the current unit-profile normal-form convention. The identity $\chi_D^{\text{unit}} = \chi_D^{\text{scale}} \chi_H^{\text{scale}}$ is exact, not a numerical coincidence. The table is illustrative and proves no all-dimensional claim.

8 The nonlinear frontier and finite-dimensional transparency

The exact unit-equilibrium stable infimum is open. The completed bounds are

$$8(m-2) \leq \chi_{\text{stable}}(m) \leq \frac{23(91m-183)}{63}. \quad (59)$$

A canonical near-threshold affine path has, at $m=3$,

$$c_3(\varepsilon) = \frac{6}{1379} + \frac{421985}{11409846}\varepsilon + O(\varepsilon^2), \quad c_3(\varepsilon) > 0 \quad (0 < \varepsilon \leq 10^{-3}). \quad (60)$$

Thus approaching the sharp linear threshold does not automatically preserve supercriticality. This is a boundary example, not a universal nonlinear gap.

Proposition 8.1 (Retuned local robustness). *Fix m and a certified L . Sufficiently small perturbations of positive rate constants, equilibrium coordinates, diffusion ratios, and interval length admit a unique nearby scalar diffusion multiplier at which the primary supercritical bifurcation and local exponential stability persist.*

Proof. Continue the simple critical eigenvalue as a smooth function of the physical parameters and one scalar diffusion multiplier. Its multiplier derivative is the nonzero transversality pairing. The implicit function theorem gives the nearby critical multiplier and equilibrium. Homogeneous and finitely many low-mode gaps persist by analytic perturbation. In a common neighborhood, a positive diffusion lower bound and a reaction-Jacobian upper bound control all high modes. The Lyapunov–Schmidt coefficients and branch spectral projection depend smoothly on parameters, so the negative cubic sign and complementary branch gap persist. One scalar multiplier is retuned; arbitrary nearby parameter points are not asserted to be critical. $\square$

Open problems.

1. Determine whether $\chi_{\text{stable}}(m) = 8(m-2)$ as an infimum at unit equilibrium.
2. Determine whether supercritical stable pattern formation has a strict nonlinear contrast gap above the linear threshold.
3. Determine the constant-optimal stable diffusion–equilibrium frontier, or equivalently the exact infimum of $\max(\chi_D, \chi_H)$.

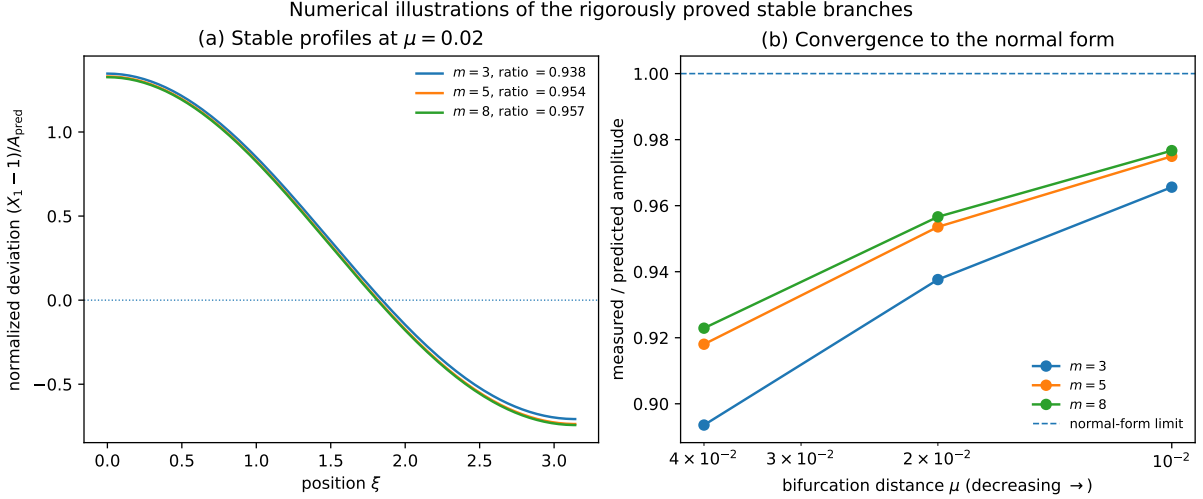


Figure 3: Numerical illustrations of the rigorously proved local patterned branches. Panel (b) compares the measured adjoint-projected amplitude with $\sqrt{-\eta_m \mu / c_m}$. Numerical illustrations are not used in any proof.

4. Determine the exact threshold for oscillatory diffusion-driven instability in this topology and whether wave instability can occur at lower diffusion or heterogeneity contrast than the sharp stationary threshold.

9 Numerical illustrations

The symbolic theorem does not use simulation. We integrated cosine-Galerkin systems for $m = 3, 5, 8$ near the exact unit-equilibrium branches, extracted the first-mode amplitude with the adjoint projection, and repeated the calculations under spatial and temporal refinement. Parameters, tolerances, profiles, and open-format data accompany the code.

10 Relation to prior work and limitations

The possibility of order- $(n - 1)$ responsible subsystems for general fixed matrices is established in multicomponent Turing theory [13, 1]; that fixed-matrix possibility is not claimed as new. The present distinction is the conjunction of one indexed binary-complex classical mass-action topology, every positive rate and equilibrium realization, all-spectrum stability of every smaller principal block, exact diffusion design, and stable nonlinear patterned branches in every dimension.

Mincheva and Craciun’s principal projected-network injectivity condition is a different reaction-network notion and is not identified with principal-block Hurwitz localization [10]. Interaction-topology and atlas studies identify broad structural features and finite collections of Turing-capable networks [9, 4, 14]; the present result instead gives one exact infinite topology family with a universal over-realizations theorem. Marcon and collaborators showed that some architectures can pattern with equally diffusing signals under their modeling assumptions [9]. For the present topology, equal diagonal diffusion cannot destabilize: it only shifts the homogeneous spectrum left. Instead, the required stationary heterogeneity is quantified exactly by (31); at unit equilibrium its contrast floor is $8(m - 2)$, and with equilibrium scaling the universal cost is (35). This is a complementary, topology-specific quantitative result about differential-diffusion tuning, not a statement about all binary-complex networks. Parameter-rich unstable cores allow derivative freedoms absent from classical mass action [16]. Exact fixed-three-species criteria address a different,

fixed-Jacobian scope [12]. Biochemical screens study interpretable reaction architectures rather than the synthetic extremal design here [11]. Monomial-steady-state results give sufficient spatial instability conditions for a restricted mass-action class [2].

The construction has one semipositive conservation law and an inflow; X_1 is not bounded by the conserved functional. The local stability theorem does not require an arbitrary-data global boundedness theorem. All diffusivities are positive and diagonal. We do not treat immobile species, cross-diffusion, projected-injectivity sharpness, weak reversibility, biochemical realization, far-from-onset dynamics, global attraction, or dimension-uniform robustness. The exact stable contrast constants remain open.

11 Discussion

The family is designed around two coupled positive-flux circuits. Their explicit two-parameter Jacobian image makes the topology-wide quantifier tractable. The long chain forces every unstable principal subsystem to contain almost all species, while the boundary triad remains Hurwitz under arbitrary positive equilibrium scaling. The unique negative order- $(n - 1)$ omission minor is the one omitting Z , which collapses stationary diffusion design to one coefficient. Finally, equilibrium scaling redistributes the necessary heterogeneity between concentrations and physical diffusion without changing the effective critical bracket or losing the negative cubic sign.

The resulting conclusion is both structural and quantitative. The largest proper unstable-subsystem order is unavoidable within this mass-action class; the exact diffusion cost is computable; stable positive patterns occur; and diffusion and equilibrium contrasts can be controlled simultaneously at the globally optimal square-root exponent. The remaining constant gap is explicit rather than hidden and provides a focused nonlinear design problem.

Data and code availability. Exact certificates, independent verifiers, mutation tests, numerical data, figure scripts, and a one-command replay accompany the manuscript.

AI-assisted research disclosure. AI systems assisted with exploratory theorem discovery, symbolic derivation, code generation, adversarial testing, proof organization, and prose editing. AI systems are not authors. The human author assumes responsibility for the manuscript. Central claims are supported by explicit proofs and independent exact implementations; neither numerical agreement nor AI confidence is treated as proof.

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